

NEWS RELEASE

TANDY CORPORATION/RADIO SHACK

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION CONTACT:

Martin B. Winston
Director of Publicity

(817) 390-3300

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Radio Shack unveils new TRS-80® Model PC-2 Pocket Computer -

faster, more powerful, with advanced features - plus advanced accessories

Radio Shack, a division of Tandy Corporation, is demonstrating working models of an extremely powerful new handheld portable computer. The new TRS-80® Pocket Computer Model PC-2 (26-3601) will be available second quarter 1982 for under \$300* at Radio Shack stores, Computer Centers and participating dealers. This new handheld computer offers advanced programming, operating and communications features that promise to greatly extend the reach of portable computing.

Among its advanced features are its capability for internal expansion with plug-in RAM and/or ROM modules, and for external expansion through a 60-pin I/O bus connector. The PC-2 features a 16K (ROM) **Extended BASIC** language interpreter with the ability to process words and messages. Programmable function keys and an LCD display with upper-, lower-case, scientific and user-definable characters provide an excellent human interface.

The TRS-80 Model PC-2 Pocket Computer's central processing unit is a high speed 8-bit custom CMOS microprocessor. The PC-2's built-in memory includes 16K of ROM and 2640 bytes of user memory. All memory information is retained even when power is off.

This 2640 byte internal memory can be expanded with plug-in modules to add

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up to 16K bytes of RAM, ROM or both combined. This extra memory capacity allows room for larger, more complex programs. A 4K RAM Expansion Module (26-3615) will be available mid-1982 for \$69.95*.

These advanced capabilities open up a great many application areas for the PC-2, including engineering, scientific and medical calculations; banking, credit, insurance, investment and financial applications; and more. In terms of both computing power and speed, its capabilities are closer to a desktop computer than any previous pocket computer, yet it costs much less than typical desktop personal computers.

Highly versatile keyboard and display are easy to work with.

The TRS-80 Model PC-2 Pocket Computer features a 65-key "typewriter-layout" keyboard with both alphabetic keys and a ten-key numeric pad. In addition, there are 6 function keys programmable for 18 functions, 18 "soft keys" and 10 pre-programmed command keys. An 80-character input buffer and cursor command keys permit corrections within a line before entry.

The PC-2's fully-addressable 7 x 156 dot matrix liquid crystal display adds to its flexibility. It provides 26 upper- and lower-case alphabetic characters, plus numbers, graphics and special characters used in engineering, science and elsewhere. Automatic scrolling displays the most recent 26 characters to help keep operations clear; a manual "playback" mode is available for lines longer than the 26 displayed characters.

For distinctive user prompting, there's even a fully-programmable beeper.

Extended BASIC.

The TRS-80 Model PC-2 Pocket Computer uses a powerful Extended BASIC Interpreter - a much faster, more versatile version of Radio Shack's original Pocket

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BASIC. Its 42 Statements, 34 Functions and 6 Commands permit program applications never before possible on a computer of this size. And this Extended BASIC is upward-compatible with TRS-80 Pocket BASIC, so programs prepared for the (original) TRS-80 Pocket Computer can be keyed into the PC-2 and run.

Words and messages are easily processed with the PC-2's new string-handling capabilities, which include the BASIC commands LEFT\$, MID\$, RIGHT\$, LEN, VAL, CHR\$ and STR\$. These character strings may be dimensioned up to 80 characters in length, and in one- or two-dimensional arrays.

The PC-2 even offers a built-in real-time quartz clock, with month, day, hour (24-hour clock format), minutes and seconds accessible from either the keyboard or from BASIC.

Advanced CPU and memory design at the heart of the PC-2.

The TRS-80 Model PC-2 Pocket Computer's central processing unit is an 8-bit custom CMOS microprocessor. Its advanced design permits direct memory access, plus maskable and timer interrupts.

System expansion.

The TRS-80 Model PC-2 Pocket Computer features a 60-pin expansion connector. This allows the use of a variety of plug-in peripherals - including the printer/plotter/cassette interface described below - plus future expansion.

Radio Shack is planning to introduce an RS-232C Interface and communications software for the TRS-80 Model PC-2 Pocket Computer late in 1982. This will allow its direct use as a terminal with many RS-232C-equipped computers and peripherals; it will also permit connection to any of Radio Shack's low-cost modems for data communications over ordinary phone lines.

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Battery or AC power with auto shut-off.

The TRS-80 Model PC-2 Pocket Computer is powered by four inexpensive AA batteries (not included). Battery life expectancy is approximately 50 hours of operation. An automatic battery-saver circuit turns power off after about seven minutes of inactivity to preserve battery life. An optional U.L. listed AC power supply (273-1455) is available for \$6.95*.

For all of its power, this tiny computer measures just 1-1/16 x 7-11/16 x 3-3/8 inches.

Unique 4-Color Printer/Plotter plus Dual Cassette Interface also coming.

Along with the TRS-80 Model PC-2 Pocket Computer, Radio Shack will be introducing a very unique peripheral for hard copy output - a four-color printer with graphic plotting capabilities - plus a dual cassette interface, all in one compact, attractive unit. The TRS-80 Model PC-2 Pocket Computer Printer/Cassette Interface (26-3605) will be available mid-1982 for under \$250*.

The TRS-80 Model PC-2 Pocket Computer Printer/Plotter adds twenty-five commands and statements to Pocket Extended BASIC. These include special statements that make it easy to plot full (216 x 512) X-/Y-/Z-axis graphics in red, blue, green and black with easily replaceable ball-point pens. Graphics resolution is an amazing 0.2 millimeters.

Text is printed in 9 different character sizes (from 4 to 36 characters per line). The Printer uses inexpensive 2-1/4" cash-register type paper. A built-in self-test feature is included.

This Printer/Cassette Interface also adds the ability to connect one or two standard cassette recorders to store and load programs and data. The use of two

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recorders allows data to be read from one cassette, updated and stored on a second cassette, for example. Each cassette is under program control from BASIC.

A pass-along 60-pin expansion connector is provided for use when the TRS-80 Model PC-2 Pocket Computer is connected. When used with an RS-232C interface (above) and an off-the-shelf modem, this permits a complete data communication and logging system.

The TRS-80 Model PC-2 Pocket Computer Printer/Cassette Interface uses built-in rechargeable batteries; a U.L. listed AC adapter/charger is included. The Printer/Plotter/Interface powers the host PC-2 when they are connected to help lengthen the life of the PC-2's own batteries. The PC-2 automatically switches the printer on and off.

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*Prices mentioned above are available at Radio Shack stores, Computer Centers and participating dealers.